

TOURNAMENT PRE-GAME, POST-GAME, AND EXPECTATIONS

The first day of a tournament is filled with excitement and nervousness, for everyone. We can't help you calm the nerves of your players, but we can make it a little easier for you, the Manager. Here are some reminders.

Show Up Early!

You need to be at the Tournament Table 1 hour before every game for the coin flip, but on the first day you need to be there even earlier — be there 1:15-1:30 before scheduled game time.

Coin Flip, Home Team

The home team is determined by a coin flip at the Tournament Table 1 hour prior to the scheduled start of the game. The team on the top of the bracket will call the coin flip. You will have 5 minutes grace before you lose the coin flip. Send someone ahead if needed.

The HOME team always occupies the 3rd base dugout.

District 8 Line-up Cards

You must use an official 4-part District 8 lineup card for every game. You will get a blank lineup card at the end of the game when you come to the tournament table to sign your Affidavit Pitching Record. **PRESS HARD**

Turn in your lineup card when you turn in your Team Affidavit at the coin flip. Please come prepared. Don't fill it out after the coin flip. That delays staff from getting the game prepared.

In Batting Order:

- Put every player on your lineup. If they are absent, put them at the very bottom and mark them absent.
- Put player numbers and positions for every player. Use position numbers (1=Pitcher, 3=First Base, 7=Left Field, etc)
- FIRST NAME, LAST NAME. WHOLE NAMES, no initials
- Put the Manager and League President on the lineup. Whole Names

Bring Your Affidavit Book ALWAYS!

The Affidavit Book contains your Team Affidavit, player verification forms, maps, combination forms, waivers, etc. Everything that was checked and signed off before the tournament started needs to be in this book and with you at every game. NO EXCEPTIONS! You will leave the Team Affidavit itself with the pitching record AND the sleeve ONLY at the Tournament Table before every game and will keep the binder with you.

Less than the number of players on your affidavit?

When you turn in your Team Affidavit and Line-up card for every game, we will review your pitching record, determine which pitchers are ineligible due to pitch count or inning count, and take note of any other issues.

If players are missing, we will ask why. Be honest and truthful. Players who are missing for multiple games may result in a call to Regional to determine any impact.

Additions or Changes?

Any changes to the affidavit must be brought to the Tournament Table MORE than 1 hour before your game. DO NOT come to the table to do the coin flip and then need to discuss changes to your Affidavit. That is NOT the time.

You cannot add a player for a single game. If they are added, they are permanently on your roster. Player additions cannot bump another player, and cannot take you beyond the maximum number of players allowed for your roster (14 for all levels except Seniors)

Affidavits will need to be reprinted and re-signed if you add a player.

If you remove a player permanently, they will be scratched and cannot return to that team for the duration of that team's tournament eligibility, nor can they play on any other LL team until their original team has been eliminated.

Coaches: If a coach will be missing for a game, you can submit a substitute coach for the game. It must come with a letter from the League President explaining the situation and naming the coach as the replacement for a specific period of time. The coach must be background checked, and must come with BOTH the Diamond Leader and Abuse Awareness training certificates. Without all of these, there is no additional coach. **DO NOT** add them to the Affidavit.

If a coach needs to be permanently scratched and replaced for the remainder of their tournament eligibility, then we will add that coach to the Affidavit at that time when you bring it to the tournament table.

Confirm and Sign your Pitching Record ; Return to the Tournament Table after the game

At the end of every game, **YOU MUST** report to the Tournament Table promptly to confirm and sign the pitching record for the game. This is your **ONLY** chance to challenge and/or fix any mistakes in the pitching record. Don't show up at the next game and try to challenge the record. It won't end well. You will also get your Lineup card for your next game.

No Batting Anywhere ; No other field usage or warmups

There is no player batting warmup anywhere at the complex hosting the tournament. There is no warmup of any kind other than on your designated field. Stretches, throwing, fielding. **NOT** Hitting. Not even whiffle balls.

Outfield Warmup:

You may take your side of the field and your dugout **ONLY AFTER** the coin flip. **DO NOT go onto the field or in the dugout until after the coin flip.**

If there is a preceding game, you may go into the outfield on your respective side of the field once the preceding game is over. You may start your outfield warmups while the preceding teams clear out of the dugout, and then may put your equipment in dugout.

Outfield warmups on your side of the outfield can start when you can go onto the field. This will last until 30 minutes prior to gametime. There is **NO INFIELD** usage of any kind, even in foul territory.

ONLY the players, the 3 Coaches on the Team Affidavit, and District Tournament Staff can be on the field at any time. No additional people can be on the field, in the dugout, or doing any warmup/prep.

NO player hitting. No player should have a bat in their hand.

Coaches may hit balls to the players on your side of the outfield. Coaches or players can act as Catcher as return.

Any player acting as Catcher **MUST** wear a proper catcher's mask. The dangling throat protector is always required. Acting as a catcher means crouching and warming up a pitcher. It also means standing next to an adult that is hitting balls to players during the infield warmup. If the player is standing next to the coach hitting balls, they are acting as a catcher and **MUST** have a catcher's mask on.

Coaches **CANNOT** warm up Pitchers. In-between innings, have a backup catcher (**WITH FACEMASK**) ready to jump behind home plate to help warm up the pitcher. There is limited time in between innings. Any delay will shorten the time the pitcher has to get ready for the upcoming inning.

Infield Warmup:

At 30 minutes prior to the start of the game, the VISITING team will get the entire field for 10 minutes. HOME team must be in their dugout. At 20 minutes, the HOME team will get the entire field for 10 minutes. VISITING team must be in their dugout.

Equipment:

Any player acting as Catcher MUST wear a proper catcher's mask. The dangling throat protector is always required.

Equipment Checks will no longer occur, per new LL rule. If you want an equipment check, its optional and must be requested at the Tournament Table checkin for your very first game. If requested, it will occur during the Infield Warmup Time by the umpires, so have your equipment along the dugout fence line (bats, helmets, catchers gear)

LEAVE ALL NON-LITTLE LEAGUE APPROVED EQUIPMENT HOME. USE OF NON-LITTLE LEAGUE EQUIPMENT IS A LL RULE VIOLATION AND YOU ARE SUBJECT TO EJECTION. THERE WILL BE NO WARNING GIVEN.

Helmets can have stickers per new LL Rule, but it cannot be excessive, obnoxious, abusive, etc.

Helmets can have a C-flap, but make sure its approved by LL for that helmet, especially if it's a different brand. Have your Helmet letters for C-flap in your Team Affidavit Binder. They can be found online.

Scorekeepers and Announcers

D8 requires for District All Star Tournaments that each team has a designated PAPER Scorekeeper and Announcer. We will advise if you will be needed, hopefully in advance. All materials needed and a script will be provided. While District 8 will do its best to ensure there are staff to handle these duties during the game, it is possible that some volunteers may be needed. But it is very likely that most teams will be called into duty at least once during their District tournament.

If you have someone on your team that wants to automatically volunteer for this, please advise at the Tournament Table when you check in.

This is NOT playtime for kids or doing only part of the game. Scorekeeping and announcing occur at the scorekeepers area behind home plate. We will not start the game without BOTH a scorekeeper / announcer.

GameChanger is allowed, but the District is not responsible for operation or for its accuracy, and is not considered official for Scorekeeping. Information on Game Changer may not be used to challenge an Umpire call or the official paper scorekeeping record. The paper book will always be the official record.

Managers can always call time-out and go to the Scorekeeper area at the home-plate fence and ask for an official pitch count. DO NOT ask anyone in the stands, and GameChanger information is not allowed on the field or dugout.

The book IS the official record of the game. NOT GameChanger.

Code of Conduct

You expect your players to come prepared to games and practices. The District expects you to come prepared as well. That means all your gear, your Affidavit Binder, your Line-Up card, etc.

We expect everyone to behave in a Sportsman-like manner. We will not tolerate abusive language, talking back to those in authority. We will not tolerate being disrespectful. Players and Coaches.

We will not tolerate hearing from a State tournament about a Conduct problem with a District 8 team. That happened twice last year at All Stars State tournaments.

Are you going to get a bad bounce? YES. This is life. Nothing is perfect, we are all human, and we are ALL volunteers. No matter what anyone says, you will need some luck to advance in the tournament.

NAF

See separate document.

Special Note on Parking. Concerts on Fri June 20, Sat June 21, Fri June 27, Sat June 28, Sat July 5

Clothing and Shoes

The preference is for coaches to look like coaches. Shirts, polo shirts, team/league branded. Pants or shorts. Think golf attire. You are representing your league. Look the part.

Here are the NO-Nos:

- Shoes: No open toed shoes. No sandals. No flip-flops. No clogs/crocs.
- Clothing cannot be “personally modified”. No cut off sleeves or shorts, no torn or ripped clothing, even if you say its “designer”.
- No ‘Daisy Duke’ style shorts.

Note that at State, and beyond, they may have their own requirements, and you will abide by them.

Music

There is no walk-up music allowed.

I would prefer no music at all, but if it get out of hand, is loud/booming/thumping, you will TOLD to turn it off. There will be frequent times when all 4 fields in the central area of NAF will be in use. That’s 8 teams that could all have their own music.

Streaming of games:

Streaming of games is allowed provided any equipment mounted on the backstop does have open clips that protrude into the field of play. There are no hoods allowed to shield the equipment or help with the streaming. If the Umpire or UIC feel that the camera or any part of its apparatus are in the way or impacting the pitcher, they have the authority to ask it be adjusted or removed. If there is a problem with the equipment or the stream during the game, you must wait until a break in the action to fix. You cannot go into the scorekeeper backstop area during active game play.